
Quantum Computation and Communications (EE798V): Problem Set 7

Department of Electrical Engineering, IIT Kanpur

Q. 1: Let the joint probability distribution of two discrete random variables X and Y are given as follows.

	$X = 1$	$X = 2$
$Y = 10$	0.1	0.25
$Y = 20$	0.2	0.2
$Y = 30$	0.1	0.15

- Calculate the joint entropy $H(X, Y)$.
- Obtain the marginal distribution $p(X)$ and use it to compute the entropy $H(X)$.
- Obtain the marginal distribution $p(Y)$ and use it to compute the entropy $H(Y)$.
- Obtain the conditional distribution $p(Y|X)$ and use it to compute the conditional entropy $H(Y|X)$.
- Obtain the conditional distribution $p(X|Y)$ and use it to compute the conditional entropy $H(X|Y)$.
- Verify that $H(X) + H(Y|X) = H(Y) + H(X|Y) = H(X, Y)$.
- Calculate the mutual information $I(X; Y)$.

Q. 2: If $f : \mathbb{R} \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$ is a concave function, then

$$f\left(\sum_{k=1}^K p_k x_k\right) \geq \sum_{k=1}^K p_k f(x_k)$$

where x_k 's are arbitrary real numbers and $\{p_k\}_{k=1}^K$ is a valid probability distribution. Moreover, the equality holds if and only if x_k 's are all equal. The above relation is known as Jensen's inequality. Note that $\log_2(\cdot)$ is a concave function; therefore, the inequality applies to it.

- Let p and q be two probability distributions with the same support set $\mathcal{X}$. Use Jensen's inequality to prove that $D(p||q) \geq 0$. Moreover, the equality holds if and only if $p(x) = q(x)$, $\forall x \in \mathcal{X}$.
- If X and Y are two random variables, then show that their mutual information can be expressed as:

$$I(X; Y) = D(p(X, Y)||p(X)p(Y))$$

- Use 2(a) and 2(b) to conclude that $I(X; Y) \geq 0$ for any two random variables X and Y . Moreover, the equality holds if and only if X and Y are independent.
- Let X be a random variable with distribution $p_X(\cdot)$ defined on a support set $\mathcal{X}$. Assume that U is a uniform random variable defined on the same support set $\mathcal{X}$. In particular,

$$p_U(x) = 1/|\mathcal{X}|, \forall x \in \mathcal{X}$$

Show that the KL divergence $D(p_X||p_U)$ can be expressed as follows.

$$D(p_X||p_U) = -H(X) + \log_2 |\mathcal{X}|$$

- Use 2(a) and 2(d) to show that $H(X) \leq \log_2 |\mathcal{X}|$ and the equality holds if and only if X is a uniformly distributed random variable.

Q. 3: Let ρ and σ be two arbitrary density operators associated with a quantum system described by a Hilbert space $\mathcal{H}$ of dimension d . Assume that the eigen decompositions of the operators are as follows.

$$\rho = \sum_{i=1}^d \lambda_i |\psi_i\rangle\langle\psi_i| \text{ and } \sigma = \sum_{i=1}^d \mu_i |\phi_i\rangle\langle\phi_i|$$

where λ_i 's and μ_i 's are (not necessarily distinct) non-negative eigenvalues of ρ and σ , respectively. Assume, for simplicity, that $\lambda_i, \mu_i > 0, \forall i \in \{1, \dots, d\}$. Recall that

$$D(\rho||\sigma) = \text{Tr}[\rho \{\log \rho - \log \sigma\}]$$

- (a) Use the properties of the density operators ρ and σ to demonstrate that $\{\lambda_i\}_{i=1}^d$ and $\{\mu_i\}_{i=1}^d$ are valid probability distributions.
- (b) Express $\log \rho$ in terms of λ_i 's and $|\psi_i\rangle$'s.
- (c) Express $\log \sigma$ in terms of μ_i 's and $|\phi_i\rangle$'s.
- (d) Show that $D(\rho||\sigma)$ can be expressed as follows.

$$D(\rho||\sigma) = \sum_{i=1}^d \lambda_i \log \lambda_i - \sum_{i=1}^d \sum_{j=1}^d \lambda_i (\log \mu_j) r_{ij}, \text{ where } r_{ij} = |\langle \psi_i | \phi_j \rangle|^2$$

- (e) Show that the set $\{r_{ij}\}_{i=1}^d$ describes a valid probability distribution for each $j \in \{1, \dots, d\}$. [Hint: Use the completeness relation.]
- (f) Use Jensen's inequality to show that

$$D(\rho||\sigma) \geq \sum_{i=1}^d \lambda_i \log \frac{\lambda_i}{q_i} \text{ where } q_i = \sum_{j=1}^d r_{ij} \mu_j$$

- (g) Show that the set $\{q_i\}_{i=1}^d$ describes a valid probability distribution.
- (h) Use the non-negativeness of the KL divergence to conclude that $D(\rho||\sigma) \geq 0$.
- (i) Use 3(h) to show that the quantum mutual information between two quantum systems A and B is always non-negative.

Q. 4: Let X, Y, Z be three random variables. Define the conditional mutual information $I(X; Z|Y)$ as follows.

$$I(X; Z|Y) = H(Z|Y) - H(Z|X, Y)$$

- (a) Use the chain rule of entropy to show that

$$I(X; Y, Z) = I(X; Y) + I(X; Z|Y)$$

- (b) Similarly show that

$$I(X; Y, Z) = I(X; Z) + I(X; Y|Z)$$

- (c) The random variables X, Y, Z are said to form a Markov chain (denoted as $X \rightarrow Y \rightarrow Z$) if X, Z are conditionally independent given Y i.e., $p(X, Z|Y) = p(X|Z)p(Y|Z)$. If $X \rightarrow Y \rightarrow Z$, show that the following inequality holds.

$$I(X; Y) \geq I(X; Z)$$

The above inequality is called the data processing inequality.

Q. 5: Consider a classical binary symmetric channel (BSC) whose input and output symbols are $X \in \{0, 1\}$ and $Y \in \{0, 1\}$, respectively. Moreover, the conditional probability matrix $p(Y|X)$ is given as follows.

$$p(Y|X) = \begin{bmatrix} 1-p & p \\ p & 1-p \end{bmatrix}$$

Assume that the input distribution is $p_X(\cdot)$.

- (a) Obtain the conditional entropy $H(Y|X)$ as a function of p and show that it is independent of $p_X(\cdot)$.
- (b) Use 2(e) to obtain an upper bound of $H(Y)$.
- (c) How should Y be distributed to achieve the upper bound?
- (d) Does there exist any distribution of X that generates the distribution of Y calculated in 5(c)?
- (e) Compute the capacity of the channel $\max_{p_X(\cdot)} I(X; Y)$.